AFRO-PRODUCTIONS ANALYSIS

Data Driven Movie Studio Launch

AUTHORS

Angela Masaki

Joy Nyuguto

David Theuri

Joel Muoki

Felista Mwangi

March 2026

OVERVIEW

Setting the Stage for Afro Productions

THE CHALLENGE

Afro Productions is entering the film industry with no production history. Every creative and financial decision carries significant risk without data-backed guidance.

OUR APPROACH

We analysed industry data across 3 key sources to answer 3 critical business questions:

- Box Office Mojo – domestic vs. foreign gross and studio performance
- The Numbers – production budgets, domestic and worldwide revenue
- TheMovieDB – genre classifications, popularity and vote data

Key Business Questions

KEY STAKEHOLDER → Head of Afro Productions New Film Studio

Q1	What film genres give the best return on investment?
Q2	What production budget range maximizes profitability?
Q3	Which release month generates the highest box office gross?

3 Datasets

The Numbers

5,782 rows · 6 columns

Budget & Revenue

Production budgets, domestic gross, and worldwide gross — the financial backbone of all ROI analysis. Financial strings cleaned, $0 values replaced.

TheMovieDB

26,517 rows · 10 columns

Genre & Popularity

Genre IDs decoded to names, vote averages and popularity scores. Films with fewer than 10 votes removed as unreliable.

Box Office Mojo

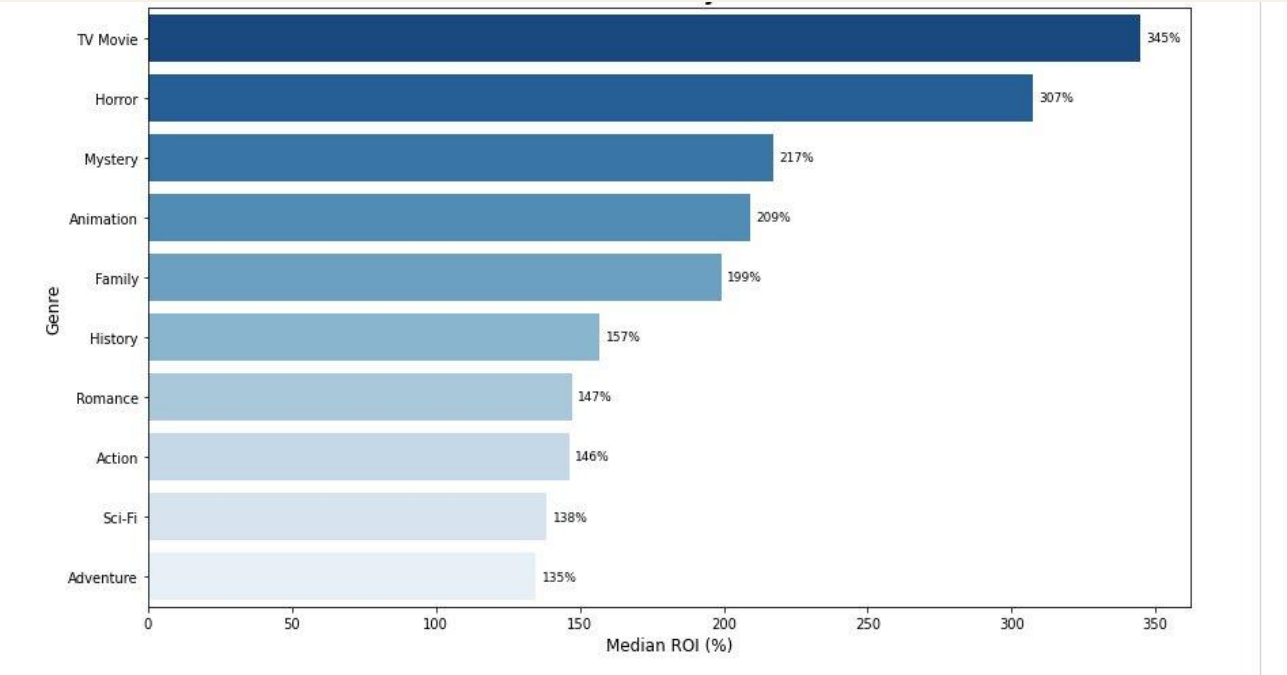
3,387 rows · 5 columns

Market Splits

Domestic vs. foreign gross and studio totals — revealing where revenue truly comes from across global markets.

All datasets cleaned: nulls removed, financial strings parsed, genres decoded, $0 values replaced with NaN.

Which Film Genres Deliver the Best ROI?



KEY FINDING

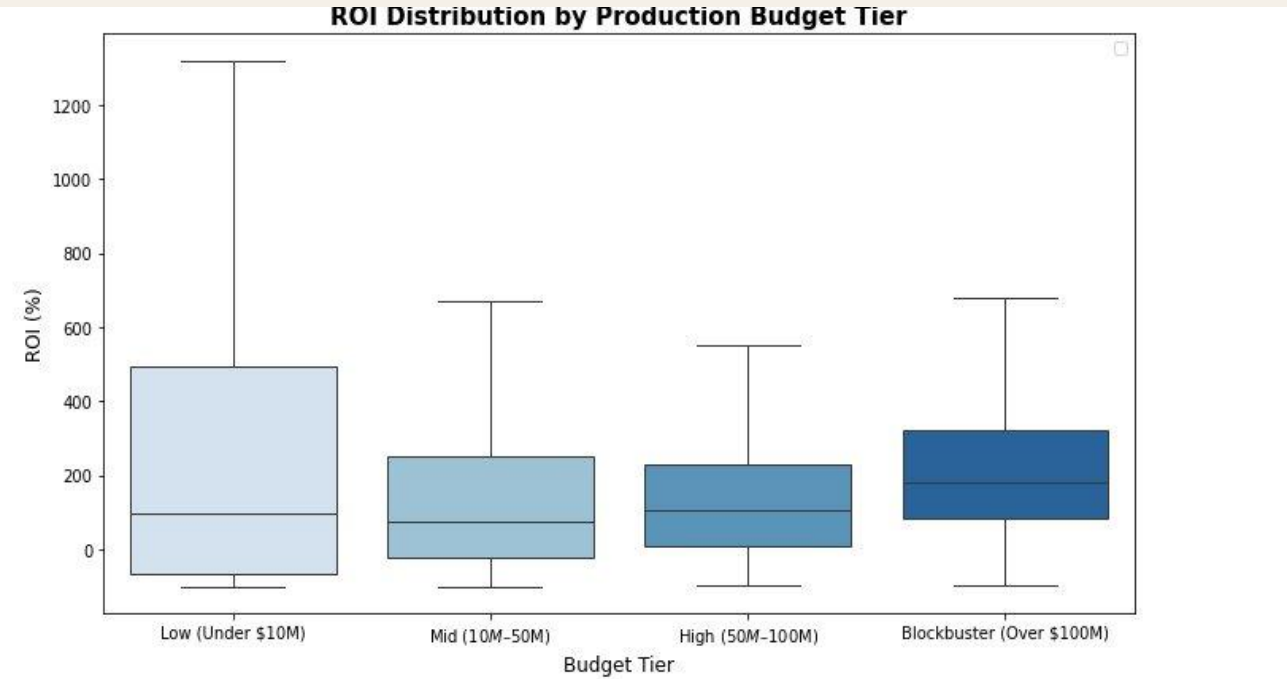
307%

Horror median ROI

Horror & Mystery consistently earn back more than double their budget — ideal for a new studio managing risk.

Note: TV Movie (345%) excluded — it refers to television productions, not theatrical film releases.

Which Budget Range Maximises Profitability?



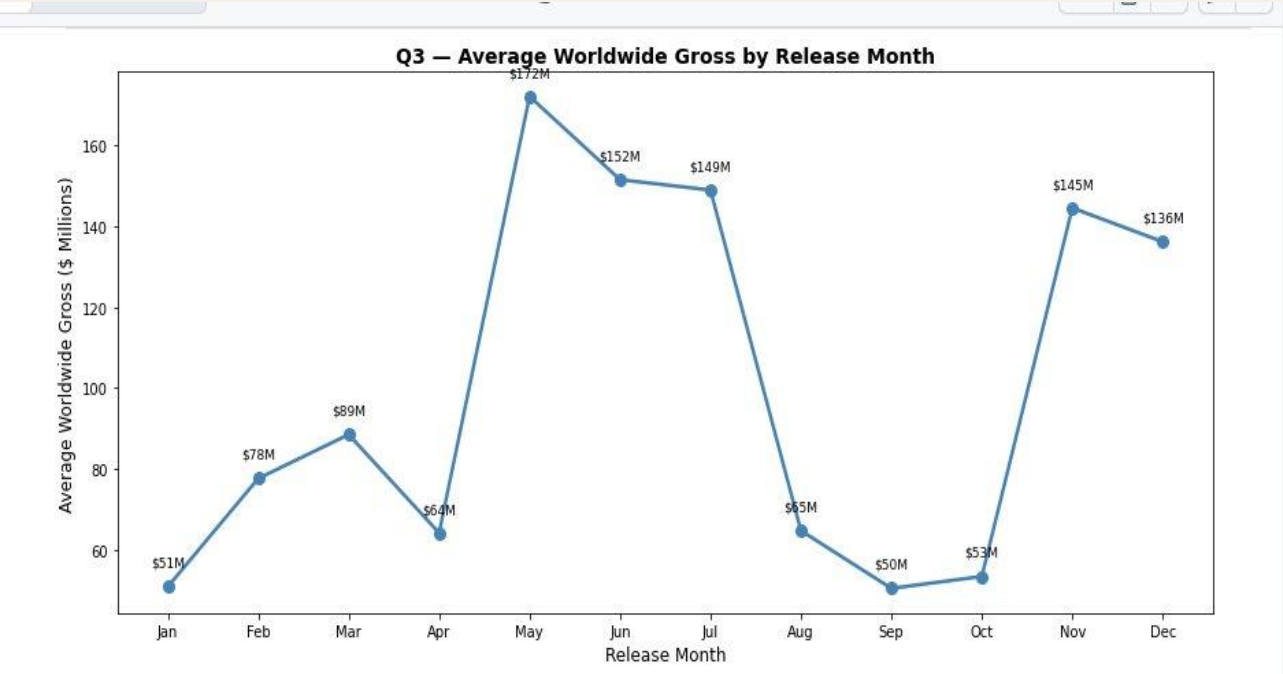
KEY FINDING

Blockbuster (Over $100M)

Highest & most consistent ROI

Low-budget films show the widest spread — high upside but very unpredictable. As budget increases, returns become more consistent and higher.

When Should We Release to Maximise Box Office?



KEY FINDING

$172M

May avg gross — #1 month

May, June & July dominate. September & October are the weakest. Target a summer release; November is a reliable backup at $145M.

Recommendations

Q1

Lead with Horror or Mystery

Horror and Mystery are the safest starting genres for a studio with no track record. They require smaller budgets, carry lower financial risk, and have historically delivered strong returns.

Q2

Target Blockbuster Budgets (Over $100M)

The studio should target Blockbuster budgets (Over $100M) — they offer the strongest and most consistent returns. Note: Blockbuster means a film with a very large production budget.

Q3

Release in May or June

Release the first film in May or June, as these months have historically attracted the largest audiences and generated the highest box office returns. November is a reliable backup.

NEXT STEPS

Where We Go From Here

1

Incorporate More Recent Data (2020-2025)

Account for how streaming and post-pandemic trends have reshaped the film industry and audience behaviour globally.

2

Conduct a Deeper Genre-Budget Analysis

Understand how ROI varies within the same genre at different spending levels to pinpoint the optimal budget for each genre.

3

Research African Market Audience Preferences

Ensure the content strategy reflects local tastes and cultural context — not just Hollywood trends — to build a loyal home-market audience.

AFRO-PRODUCTIONS ANALYSIS

Thank You

We appreciate your time and attention.

Questions & Discussion

We welcome your questions on our findings, methodology, or strategic recommendations.